

First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Governance in Canada, Grade 12

University/College Preparation (NDG4M)

OVERVIEW

The systematic forced removal of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit traditional governance structures by successive governments in colonial and post-Confederation Canada continues to shape the current realities of Indigenous peoples in this country. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities face fundamental questions about how they can renew their relationship with governments in Canada and reaffirm their own governance structures.

Questions related to colonial legacies, Indigenous rights, self-determination, sovereignty / self-governance, reconciliation, justice, equality, land claims, cultural traditions, economic development, and land use are all fundamental to the subject of governance. This course provides students with an overview of these and other issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance in Canada. Students explore current realities related to law and governance and their historical roots. The course covers a range of issues, ideas, and developments, from precontact governance structures to contemporary effects of colonization and various processes and strategies for reconciliation. Students investigate the legacies of colonialist policies, legislation, and case law as well as changes that have occurred since the recognition of Aboriginal rights in the Constitution Act and the interpretation of these rights by courts in Canada. Students examine issues related to self-governance, self-determination, and sovereignty, including traditions, values, principles, responsibilities, and strategies that are associated with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit self-determination. Through their investigations, students identify cultural factors that have contributed to existing Indigenous governance structures and give consideration to elements that may improve the effectiveness of these structures. Learning about the changing relationships between Indigenous peoples and colonial, federal, provincial, and territorial governments in Canada, from early treaties and land claims to calls for renewal of a nation-to-nation relationship, will help students develop a deeper understanding of the current realities facing Indigenous people in the pursuit of self-determination in Canada.

STRANDS

This course has four strands. Strand A, which focuses on the legal studies inquiry process, is followed by three content strands, which are organized thematically. The four strands are as follows:

A. The Legal Studies Inquiry Process and Skill Development

Students learn how to use the legal studies inquiry process as well as the concepts of legal thinking to guide their investigations into issues, events, developments, and ideas. Although the inquiry strand is presented separately from the content strands (strands B–D), in practice students constantly apply the skills, approaches, and concepts included in strand A as they work to achieve the expectations in the content strands.

B. The Historical Context

Students explore the historical foundations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance. They develop their understanding of the scope and intent of treaties and land claim agreements between Indigenous peoples and colonial and federal governments. They also analyse colonial, federal, and provincial policies, legislation, and judicial decisions prior to the 1980s and the impact they have had on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities and on their relationship with governments in Canada.

C. Support for and Challenges to Indigenous Rights

Students focus on developments since 1982, with a particular emphasis on the recognition of Aboriginal rights in the Constitution Act, 1982, and the implications of this recognition for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit and their changing relationships with governments in Canada. Students explore Indigenous rights and how they have been affected not only by the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms and by post-Charter laws and jurisprudence but also by activism on the part of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and organizations.

D. Self-Determination, Sovereignty, and Self-Governance

Students examine various issues related to Indigenous self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance in Canada. Students develop their understanding of principles and responsibilities related to sovereignty and self-governance, the importance of land-based issues and how they relate to self-determination, and ways in which various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and organizations in Canada have advocated for self-determination and reconciliation. Finally, students compare issues affecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities in Canada with those facing Indigenous peoples in the rest of the world.

LEGAL INQUIRY AND THE CONCEPTS OF LEGAL THINKING

Educators are encouraged to refer to the general discussion of the research and inquiry process that appears in the introduction to this document (see page 24) for necessary information relating to all First Nations, Métis, and Inuit studies courses. What follows is a brief discussion of the *legal* studies inquiry process, and the concepts of legal thinking, in the context of the present course. For further information on these topics, teachers may wish to consult *The Ontario Curriculum, Grades 11 and 12: Canadian and World Studies, 2015*, p. 510.

In this course, students use the legal studies inquiry process to investigate issues, events, and developments related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance in Canada; to gather, analyse, assess, and evaluate evidence from a wide variety of sources, including Indigenous knowledge sources; to make informed judgements and reach viable conclusions; and to communicate those judgements and conclusions effectively.

As in all courses that consider events, developments, and issues from a legal perspective, it is crucial that students not simply learn various facts but that they develop the ability to think and to process content in ways that are most appropriate to the material. To that end, this course focuses on developing students' ability to apply the following concepts of legal thinking:

- legal significance
- continuity and change
- interrelationships
- legal perspective

In the context of the present course, the concept of *legal significance* requires students to consider the impact of treaties, land claim agreements, legislation, court decisions, and legal/political structures on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities. Students also apply this concept to help them analyse the importance of legal principles, case law, and social forces in the evolution of laws affecting Indigenous peoples in Canada. The concept of *continuity and change* is also relevant to investigations into the evolution of laws, as students determine how and why laws, legal structures, and legal issues relating to Indigenous governance have changed, as well as what issues remain unresolved and why. When students apply the concept of *interrelationships*, they consider how laws have affected and continue to affect Indigenous peoples in Canada and how Indigenous peoples have affected and continue to affect laws. In addition, they focus on interactions between First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities and colonial, federal, provincial, and territorial governments. Finally, the concept of *legal perspective* requires students to consider key legal principles, including those related to self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance, land claims, Crown duties, reconciliation, and Aboriginal rights under the Constitution Act. Students are encouraged to consider the perspectives of different stakeholders – First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities as well as federal, provincial, and territorial governments – on issues relating to Indigenous governance.

It is important to note that, although students use the concepts of legal thinking to guide and structure the inquiry process in this course, the topics they investigate are not only legal but also political, economic, social, and cultural. Any study of First Nations, Métis,

and Inuit perspectives and realities must acknowledge the interconnected nature of many of the issues that are of great significance to Indigenous peoples. For example, the assertion of the right of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities to sovereignty/self-governance involves the wish to have both legal and political autonomy but also the autonomy to make economic decisions and develop social institutions that reflect Indigenous beliefs and values. Similarly, the relationship between land-based issues, Indigenous rights, and self-determination encompasses not just legal issues, but also social, political, cultural, economic, and environmental ones.

First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Governance in Canada, Grade 12

University/College Preparation

NDG4M

This course explores aspects of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance in Canada as well as laws, policies, and judicial decisions that have affected and continue to affect the lives of Indigenous peoples in this country. Students will investigate historical and contemporary relations between First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and colonial, federal, and provincial/territorial governments and will develop their understanding of Indigenous rights in Canada. Students will examine how traditional values and cultural practices inform models of Indigenous governance and leadership as they explore strategies being used to revitalize and strengthen First Nations, Métis, and Inuit sovereignty, self-governance, and self-determination in Canada.

Prerequisite: Any Grade 11 university, university/college, or college preparation course in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit studies, Canadian and world studies, or social sciences and humanities

A. THE LEGAL STUDIES INQUIRY PROCESS AND SKILL DEVELOPMENT

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. The Inquiry Process in Legal Studies:** use the legal studies inquiry process and the concepts of legal thinking when investigating issues pertaining to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance and Indigenous law in Canada;
- A2. Developing Transferable Skills:** apply in everyday contexts skills developed through the study of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance and Indigenous law, and identify various careers in which a background in these areas might be an asset.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Inquiry Process in Legal Studies

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** formulate different types of questions to guide investigations into current and historical issues relating to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance and Indigenous law in Canada (e.g., factual questions: *What is the current process for making laws to regulate economic activity in First Nations communities?; What are some key legal arguments that can be used to support and to refute the right to build an oil pipeline or mine on or near treaty lands or historic Métis communities, or in Inuit Nunangat? What are the main similarities and differences in the legislative bases for the political relationship between the federal government and First Nations, Métis, and Inuit in Canada?; causal questions: Why are issues associated with current First Nations treaty rights and Métis and Inuit rights most commonly dealt with through litigation rather than negotiation?*)
- A1.2** select and organize relevant evidence, data, and information on issues, events, and/or developments relating to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance and Indigenous law in Canada from a variety of primary and secondary sources, including Indigenous knowledge sources (e.g., primary sources: *case law; legislation; treaties; testimony before commissions and tribunals; photographs; interviews with community members, legal experts, Métis Senators, knowledge keepers, and/or knowledge holders; secondary sources: newspaper articles, journal articles, textbooks, documentaries, most websites*), ensuring that their sources reflect multiple perspectives
- Sample questions:** “Whose views or perspectives are reflected in this source? Whose views are absent or overlooked? What types of sources might reflect those other perspectives?”
- A1.3** assess the accuracy and credibility of sources relevant to their investigations (e.g., *identify the lens through which the source reports information; compare the information in one source to that in other sources in order to assess its accuracy; compare how the evidence is constructed or presented in different sources; consider the influence of purpose, intended audience, bias, and values*)
- Sample questions:** “For what explicit and/or implicit purpose does this source seem to have been created? How and why might that purpose affect the source’s reliability?” “What evidence does this source use to support its argument? Does this evidence clearly support the argument?”
- A1.4** interpret and analyse evidence, data, and information relevant to their investigations, using a variety of tools, strategies, and approaches appropriate for inquiry in legal studies (e.g., *extract key arguments from sources and record them on graphic organizers to facilitate comparison; discuss ideas and information with their peers to help them clarify their understanding; assess the ethical implications of arguments or evidence*)
- Sample questions:** “When you analyse these differing interpretations of this information, which is most convincing to you? Why?” “What are the ethical implications for Indigenous and non-Indigenous communities in Canada of the evidence and/or arguments presented in this source?”

A1.5 use the concepts of legal thinking (i.e., legal significance, continuity and change, interrelationships, and legal perspective) when analysing, evaluating evidence about, and formulating conclusions and/or judgements regarding issues, events, and/or developments relating to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance and Indigenous law in Canada (*e.g., apply the concept of legal significance to help them assess the impact of a court decision on First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit individuals and communities; consider the concept of continuity and change when investigating approaches used by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities to assert the right to self-governance or sovereignty; apply the concept of interrelationships when analysing how social attitudes have affected policy relating to Indigenous peoples in Canada; consider the concept of legal perspective when assessing Aboriginal rights under the Constitution Act, 1982*)

Sample questions: “How has the 1973 Supreme Court decision in *Calder v. British Columbia* affected subsequent land claims in the courts? How has the 2003 decision in *R. v. Powley* affected Métis rights? What concepts of legal thinking might you apply to help you assess the importance of these decisions? Do you think that these are landmark cases? What criteria should be met for a case to be considered a landmark?”

A1.6 evaluate and synthesize their findings to formulate conclusions and/or make informed judgements or predictions about the issues, events, and/or developments they are investigating

Sample questions: “What were the most important factors that had a bearing on the 1997 decision in *Delgamuukw v. British Columbia*?” “Does what you have found about the positions of different parties on this current issue affecting First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit communities enable you to predict how the issue will be addressed or resolved in the future? What arguments can you use to support your prediction?”

A1.7 communicate their ideas, arguments, and conclusions using various formats and styles, as appropriate for the audience and purpose (*e.g., a mock trial with a group of peers, using the Charter to challenge a law or practice that discriminates against First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit in Canada; a classroom debate on the most effective methods for resolving a land-based dispute; a presentation for members of the school and local community on the legacy of the residential school system; a case study on the local governance structure in a First Nation community; a transcript of and report on an interview with an Indigenous person*

with expertise on a question of importance to a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community; an essay on the evolution of the Indian Act; a petition to lobby for political change to address violence against Indigenous women and girls; a blog on court challenges of relevance to Indigenous rights; a documentary exploring income inequality between Indigenous people and non-Indigenous Canadians; a position paper on taxation as it relates to First Nations individuals and communities)

Sample questions: “What format is best suited to communicating your findings? In selecting this format, have you considered both the needs of your audience and the most effective and engaging way of presenting the information?” “How can you communicate your findings in ways that are sensitive to those who may have experienced marginalization and/or trauma?”

A1.8 use accepted forms of documentation (*e.g., footnotes or endnotes, author/date citations, reference lists, bibliographies, credits*) to acknowledge all sources of information (*e.g., legal references [i.e., case law, legislation], websites, blogs, books, journals, articles, oral evidence/interviews, archival sources*)

A1.9 assess and use terminology appropriate to the audience and purpose when communicating the results of their investigations (*e.g., vocabulary specific to their inquiry; appropriate terminology related to the names of Indigenous communities and to Indigenous protocols and practices*)

Sample questions: “Why is it important to be aware of the significance of terminology and naming when conducting research and/or communicating the results of research on issues relating to First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit communities?” “Why is the term ‘Indian’ still used in the Canadian legal system? When is its usage appropriate? In what context might you use the term ‘Aboriginal’? When might the term ‘Indigenous’ be more appropriate? When would it be better to use ‘First Nations, Métis, and Inuit’? Are there other words or names we should be using, and when is it appropriate to use them?”

A2. Developing Transferable Skills

Throughout this course, students will:

A2.1 describe several ways in which investigations related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance and Indigenous law in Canada can help them develop essential skills (*e.g., skills related to reading texts, document use, computer use, oral*

communication, numeracy, literacy, decision making, critical thinking) as well as skills related to the citizenship education framework,* including advocacy skills, that can be transferred to postsecondary opportunities, the world of work, and their future lives

A2.2 demonstrate in everyday contexts attributes, skills, and work habits developed through the study of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance and Indigenous law in Canada (*e.g., demonstrate attributes related to respect, cooperation, and reciprocity to build positive relationships with individuals or groups from diverse backgrounds; use critical-thinking skills to evaluate the validity of arguments in a documentary; use listening and oral communication skills to engage in informed discussions; apply work habits such as initiative to take action on an issue, or collaboration to work successfully with others in the classroom, workplace, or local community*)

A2.3 use the concepts of legal thinking when analysing current events relating to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance and Indigenous law in Canada in order to enhance their understanding of these events and their role as informed citizens (*e.g., to help them identify competing rights relevant to a land claim and/or treaty rights issue in the news; to help them understand how and why a current event related to the rights of Indigenous people in another part of the world is similar to or different from the situation in Canada; to help them understand the current demands of a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit advocacy organization*)

Sample question: “How might applying the concepts of continuity and change and legal perspective deepen your understanding of the issues around a current land claim dispute?”

A2.4 identify various careers in which a background in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance and/or Indigenous law might be an asset (*e.g., business owner, employee of a governmental or non-governmental organization, lawyer, mediator, negotiator, policy analyst, researcher, representative of a provincial or territorial organization*), and compare the education and/or training pathways for selected careers

Sample question: “Why might it be useful to have education, training, and experience in Indigenous law and/or First Nations, Métis, and Inuit governance structures when working in the forestry, alternative energy, oil and gas, fisheries, and/or real estate sectors?”

* The citizenship education framework appears on [page 11](#).

B. THE HISTORICAL CONTEXT

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Treaties and Land Claim Agreements:** demonstrate an understanding of the intent and scope of, and processes associated with, historical treaties and land claim agreements between Indigenous peoples and colonial, federal, and/or provincial/territorial governments in Canada prior to 1982;
- B2. Legislation:** describe historical legislation at the colonial and federal levels that has affected First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities in Canada, and assess its impact;
- B3. Political Relations:** analyse relationships between Indigenous peoples and colonial, federal, and/or provincial/territorial governments in Canada prior to 1980.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Treaties and Land Claim Agreements

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify the areas of Canada that are covered by historical treaties and land claim agreements that date from prior to 1980 between various Indigenous peoples and colonial, federal, and/or provincial/territorial governments

- B1.2** analyse the spirit and intent of, and processes involved in, key historical treaties between First Nations and colonial/federal governments in Canada (e.g., *the Covenant Chain, the Dish with One Spoon Treaty and wampum, the Robinson-Superior and Robinson-Huron treaties of 1850, the Treaty of 1752, the Treaty of Peace and Friendship of 1760, the Treaty of Niagara, the Numbered Treaties*)

Sample questions: “What was the general intent of First Nations in entering into historical treaties with the colonial or federal government? Did their intent differ from that of the governments with which they negotiated?” “Who were the legal partners negotiating the Numbered Treaties?” “How were historical treaty negotiations recorded? Which of the treaties were oral agreements? What are some ways in which the essence of the oral agreement changed when written texts of the treaty were produced?” “What are some significant differences among the historical treaties, such as the Treaty of Peace and Friendship and the Numbered Treaties, with respect to their spirit and/or intent? How might you account for these differences?”

- B1.3** explain the force and scope of key historical treaties between First Nations and colonial/federal governments, with reference to both their legal and cultural implications (e.g., *the legal limitations placed on both First Nations and colonial/federal governments by these treaties; differences in approaches to land distribution and ownership between First Nations and colonial/federal governments, and their implications for the negotiation and enforcement of treaties; differences between early and later treaties in their impact on the lives of First Nations individuals and communities*)

Sample questions: “Why might First Nations and colonial/federal governments have different ideas about the force and scope of a treaty?” “What implications did different views about land use/ownership have for treaty enforcement?” “What rights did First Nations surrender under the Numbered Treaties? What rights did they maintain? How did limitations on rights affect traditional ways of life?” “What was the impact of the exclusion of the Métis as a collective from most treaties?”

- B1.4** explain the intent, scope, and processes associated with land claim agreements prior to 1982 (e.g., *with reference to the federal government’s 1973 land claims policy; the James Bay and Northern Quebec Agreement of 1977; the Northeastern Quebec Agreement of 1978; early negotiations towards the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement*)

Sample questions: “What was the significance of the federal government’s 1973 land claims policy and its distinction between specific and comprehensive land claims?” “What were some

factors that led to the initiation of research and negotiations that ultimately resulted in the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement?”

B2. Legislation

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 explain the motivation for and impact on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities of key pieces of colonial legislation, including the Royal Proclamation of 1763 (e.g., *the Quebec Act, 1774; the Crown Lands Protection Act, 1839; the Gradual Civilization Act, 1857; the Management of Indian Lands and Property Act [Indian Land Act], 1860; the British North America Act [BNA Act], 1867*)

Sample questions: “What criteria would you use to determine the significance of the Royal Proclamation for First Nations individuals and communities at the time?” “What are some of the factors that helped shape British colonial legislation related to First Nations? In your opinion, were these laws developed in good faith? What evidence supports your answer?” “What was the significance of the BNA Act’s giving the new federal government jurisdiction over ‘Indians and lands reserved for the Indians’?”

B2.2 describe key federal legislation in Canada prior to the 1960s that was of relevance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities, with reference to both its motivation and content (e.g., *the recognition of Métis rights in the Manitoba Act, 1870; the colonization of the West under the Dominion Lands Act, 1872; the social and political beliefs that underpinned the Indian Act of 1876; the power granted Indian agents under the Indian Act; the requirement under the 1920 Indian Act that First Nations children attend residential schools; the 1924 amendment of the Indian Act to include Inuit; the 1951 amendment to the Indian Act to exclude Inuit*)

Sample questions: “What were some of the factors that shaped the Manitoba Act’s provisions with respect to Métis?” “What attitudes and aims underpinned the original Indian Act? How were these aims reflected in the content of the act? Do you think that amendments to that act reflect any changes in these attitudes and aims? Why, or why not?”

B2.3 assess the impact that federal legislation in Canada had on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities prior to the 1960s (e.g., *the impact of the Indian Act, including its requirement for children to attend residential*

schools, its criteria for who was – and was not – a “status Indian” and for losing status – for instance, on completion of postsecondary education or military service or, for women, on marrying a non-status man; the impact of the Canadian Bill of Rights, 1960, on the rights of “Indians”)

Sample questions: “What aspects of life did the original Indian Act affect? What were some of its major amendments? How did these amendments compound the disadvantages faced by First Nations communities? Which amendments do you think had the greatest impact? Why?”

B3. Political Relations

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 identify various factors that affected the political relationship between Indigenous peoples and colonial, federal, and/or provincial/territorial governments in Canada prior to 1980, and explain their impact (e.g., *with reference to the need for allies in colonial wars; increased colonization; the desire of the federal government to assert its authority; paternalistic attitudes of lawmakers; hardship resulting from highly restrictive and disruptive legislation*)

Sample questions: “In what ways did the expansion of settlement in western Canada influence both the policies of the federal government towards First Nations and Métis and the response of First Nations and Métis to these policies?” “What was the federal government’s Métis scrip policy in the nineteenth century? How did this policy affect relations between Métis and the government?” “In what ways did differing ideas about land use and property ownership affect relations between Indigenous peoples and governments in Canada?” “How and why did the treatment of Métis by governments differ from province to province?”

B3.2 describe some decisions of the judicial branch of the government that were related to Aboriginal rights and title prior to 1980 (e.g., *St Catherine’s Milling and Lumber Co. v. the Queen, 1889; Re Eskimo, 1939; Calder v. British Columbia, 1973; Hamlet of Baker Lake v. Minister of Indian Affairs and Northern Development, 1979*), and analyse how they affected relations between governments and Indigenous peoples

Sample questions: “What was the key finding in the *Calder* case? In what ways did this decision influence how the federal government approached the issue of First Nations and Métis

title? What impact did it have on relations between the government and Indigenous peoples?"

B3.3 describe some ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, and/or advocacy groups responded to and/or tried to influence relations with governments in Canada prior to 1980 (*e.g., the Penetanguishene Métis Petition of 1840; the Red River Resistance or North-West Resistance; establishing organizations such as the League of Indians of Canada, the National Indian Brotherhood, or Inuit Tapirisat of Canada; covertly holding banned ceremonies; resistance among Inuit to the numbered disc system of identification; issuing the Red Paper in response to the White Paper; testimony before the Berger Commission*)

Sample questions: "Under what circumstances did First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit resort to armed resistance against the government?" "What were some similarities and differences between key events leading to, and the impact of, the Sayer Trial at Red River in 1849 and the Mica Bay Incident of 1849–50?" "What ideas were expressed in the National Indian Brotherhood's 1972 policy paper *Indian Control of Indian Education*? What was the paper a reaction to?"

C. SUPPORT FOR AND CHALLENGES TO INDIGENOUS RIGHTS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Rights:** demonstrate an understanding of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit rights in Canada and of various factors that affect them;
- C2. Constitutional/Charter Rights:** demonstrate an understanding of the impact that the Constitution Act, 1982 and the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms have had on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit rights in Canada;
- C3. Law and Policy:** analyse how various laws, policies, and agreements since the 1980s have affected First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities in Canada;
- C4. Changing Political Relations:** analyse aspects of the relationship between Indigenous peoples and federal and provincial/territorial governments since the 1980s, including factors that have affected these relationships.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Rights

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** describe inherent First Nations, Métis, and Inuit rights in Canada and how they are connected to traditional territories and cultures

Sample questions: “How and why is the fact that First Nations and Inuit have lived on specific lands since ‘time immemorial’ relevant to modern-day land claims?” “How and why is it relevant to modern-day land claims that Métis ancestors lived on specific lands ever since the early years of the fur trade?” “What is the legal significance of the term *terra nullius* with respect to traditional territories of First Nations?” “How has Canada recognized and affirmed the inherent rights of Indigenous peoples?” “Where are inherent rights of Indigenous peoples defined in Canada’s legal system? How are inherent rights perceived in Canadian courts?” “What is the significance of the 1973 *Calder* decision with respect to traditional lands and inherent rights?” “In the 1996 case *R. v. Van der Peet*, how did the Supreme Court of Canada interpret the relationship between traditional culture and inherent rights?”

- C1.2** describe circumstances in which individual and/or group rights and freedoms of various Indigenous peoples in Canada have been threatened, limited, and/or violated since the 1980s (*e.g., through categorization as “status Indians” and/or loss of status, loss of treaty rights, lack of recognition of hunting/fishing rights, practices that degrade the environment, failure to recognize tax exemptions for goods and services*), and explain the impact of these threats, limitations, and/or violations

Sample questions: “Why do you think that government-issued Secure Certificate of Indian Status cards are sometimes scrutinized at the Canada–U.S. border? What is the legal significance of such scrutiny?” “What is the difference between a Métis Nation of Ontario citizenship card and a Certificate of Indian Status?” “In what ways are the First Nations rights that were included in the Jay Treaty of 1794 threatened or limited by present-day immigration and security issues?” “What impact have limitations on traditional use of lands had on the lives of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit individuals and/or communities?” “Why did Inuit of Nunavut have to extinguish their Indigenous rights to become beneficiaries of the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement?”

C1.3 explain, with reference to some key decisions (e.g., *R. v. Moosehunter*, 1981; *R. v. Badger*, 1996; *R. v. Marshall*, 1999; *R. v. Powley*, 2003; *Mikisew Cree First Nation v. Canada*, 2005; *Grassy Narrows First Nation v. Ontario*, 2014), how historical treaty rights have been interpreted by the courts since the 1980s

Sample questions: “What approach did the Supreme Court take in the *Badger* decision with respect to treaty rights? What are the implications of this judgement for the interpretation of historical treaties?” “What are some court decisions that have found infringements of existing treaty rights? What is the legal significance of these decisions?” “What are the main similarities and differences between the *Van der Peet* test and the *Powley* test with respect to Métis rights?”

C1.4 assess various ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities in Canada have acted to protect treaty rights and/or land claim agreements since the 1980s (e.g., *through complaints to the ombudsman or to the United Nations [UN], litigation before courts or tribunals, testimony before inquiries or commissions, petitions, voting, pressure groups, media campaigns*)

Sample questions: “What role did the Assembly of First Nations and Inuit Tapirisat of Canada (now Inuit Tapiriit Kanatami) play in entrenching Aboriginal rights in the Canadian constitution?” “How and why did James Matthew Simon use the courts to recognize and protect his treaty rights?”

C2. Constitutional/Charter Rights

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 assess the significance of section 35 of the Constitution Act, 1982, including its ability to guarantee Aboriginal rights and accommodate the needs of diverse First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities

Sample questions: “How did the enactment of section 35 bring about fundamental changes in how Canada’s legal system addresses Aboriginal and treaty rights?” “What does it mean to Indigenous peoples to have Aboriginal rights entrenched in the constitution?” “Do you think that the Constitution Act, 1982 provides equal recognition for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit? Why, or why not?” “How might the clause that states that ‘the existing aboriginal and treaty rights of the aboriginal peoples of Canada are hereby recognized and affirmed’ affect the rights of future generations of Indigenous

peoples in Canada?” “What means do Métis presently have to bring claims relating to section 35 rights?”

C2.2 identify some of the rights and freedoms protected by the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms (the Charter) (e.g., *the “fundamental freedoms”, democratic rights, mobility rights, legal rights, equality rights, language rights, minority language education rights*), and explain their significance for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities

Sample questions: “What are some ways in which the general rights and freedoms guaranteed by the Charter have affected Indigenous peoples in Canada?” “How might other Charter rights and freedoms compete with Aboriginal rights?” “What implications has the Charter clause referring to gender equality had for Indigenous peoples?” “Why was section 25 added to the Charter? What implications does that section have for Indigenous self-governance?” “How could the Charter be used as a vehicle for educational reform that would benefit First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities?” “What implications has the Charter’s equality rights clause had on government funding and financial support for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities?”

C2.3 explain the role of the judiciary in interpreting and enforcing the Charter and other constitutional provisions in decisions that have affected First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit individuals and communities in Canada (e.g., *with reference to Derrickson v. Derrickson*, 1986; *R. v. Sparrow*, 1990; *R. v. Marshall*, 1999; *McIvor v. Canada*, 2009; *Daniels v. Canada*, 2016)

Sample questions: “What role did the Charter play in the *McIvor* decision? What impact did this decision have on First Nations communities with respect to their membership? How has this ruling affected the lives of many First Nations women and their children? What actions did the government take with respect to this ruling?” “How has the *Daniels* decision affected the relationship between the Crown and Métis?”

C3. Law and Policy

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 analyse differences between historical treaties and modern land claim agreements, with reference to process, spirit, and intent as well as the impact of these agreements on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities in Canada (e.g., *differences between the Numbered*

Treaties and the James Bay and Northern Quebec Agreement, the Nisga'a Final Agreement, or the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement)

Sample questions: “What is the role of the federal government in the treaty process with First Nations communities today? How has this role changed over time?” “How would a modern-day land claim be initiated and negotiated? How would those processes differ from those associated with historical treaties?” “What impact has the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement had on Inuit and on Inuit governance?”

C3.2 analyse laws and political policies since the 1970s that have affected First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities, with a particular focus on laws and policies that have attempted to address the legacy of domination by colonial, federal, and provincial/territorial governments (e.g., *the apology for residential schools, the establishment of the Royal Commission on Aboriginal Peoples, the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement, the Labrador Inuit Lands Claims Agreement, the Inuvialuit Final Agreement, the Safe Drinking Water for First Nations Act, policy initiatives of the Ontario Ministry of Indigenous Affairs, the creation of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission, the Métis Nation of Ontario Secretariat Act, 2015*)

Sample questions: “What prompted the federal government’s 2008 apology to former students of residential schools? What were some responses to this apology? What actions or initiatives followed it? How has the government attempted to address the legacy of the residential school system? How successful do you think these attempts have been?” “What was the rationale for Bill S-8 (the Safe Drinking Water for First Nations Act)? What is the regulatory process for implementing the act within First Nations communities?” “What are some provincial laws or policies that have affected Indigenous peoples in Canada? Has their impact been largely positive or negative?” “How does the 2008 Ontario–Métis Nation Framework Agreement seek to protect and promote the distinct culture, identity, and heritage of Métis in Ontario?” “How does the Métis Nation of Ontario Secretariat Act support Métis self-government?” “How has the Nunavut Land Claim Agreement impacted Inuit communities and their self-determination?”

C3.3 assess how current and proposed legislation may affect the rights of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit individuals and communities in Canada (e.g., *with reference to legislation affecting the environment, the economy, freedom of speech and assembly, educational policy*)

C3.4 explain how social attitudes, values, and/or trends have influenced laws and government policies, both in Canada and internationally, that have affected and/or continue to affect the lives of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit individuals and communities in Canada (e.g., *with reference to attitudes towards the rights of Indigenous peoples, environmental protection, or women’s rights, including the rights of Indigenous women; values related to individual liberties, human rights, self-determination; trends such as climate change, the increasing visibility of violence against Indigenous women*)

Sample questions: “Why was the government of Stephen Harper under pressure to establish an inquiry into murdered and missing First Nations, Métis, and Inuit women in Canada? Why did his government resist this pressure? What factors do you think accounted for the decision to establish such an inquiry in 2016?” “How might the opening up of the Northwest Passage as a result of climate change, and the claim by the United States that the passage is in international waters, affect the lives of Inuit?” “Why did the federal government appoint Thomas Isaac to explore ways to advance reconciliation with the Métis? What are the outcomes of Isaac’s report?”

C4. Changing Political Relations

By the end of this course, students will:

C4.1 analyse key factors, including specific policies (e.g., *requirements relating to consultation and accommodation; increasing education and activism among Indigenous individuals; the process involved in modern-day comprehensive land claims; legal concepts such as the doctrine of discovery, sui generis, the honour of the Crown*), that since the 1980s have affected and/or continue to affect the relationship between Indigenous peoples and Canadian governments

Sample questions: “What is the principle behind the ‘honour of the Crown’ in the context of the relationship between Indigenous peoples and Canadian governments? What is the significance of this principle? How has it affected relationships between Indigenous peoples and Canadian governments?” “How did the 2016 decision in *Daniels v. Canada* clarify ways in which legislative authority applies to Métis and non-status Indians? Why did Métis want the court in *Daniels* to rule that they were ‘Indians’?” “What is the legal definition of the Métis Nation in Canada? In Ontario?”

C4.2 explain the Supreme Court of Canada’s finding (in *Haida Nation v. British Columbia*, 2004, and *Taku River Tlingit First Nation v. British Columbia*, 2004) that the federal government has a duty to consult and accommodate Indigenous peoples, and analyse the impact of this finding on the relationship between Indigenous peoples and Canadian governments

Sample questions: “How did the failure to consult with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit partners affect the relationship between Indigenous peoples and the federal and/or provincial governments? Do you think the *Haida Nation* and *Taku River Tlingit First Nation* rulings have resulted in significant changes in the consultation process? Why, or why not?”

C4.3 explain the Crown’s fiduciary obligation towards Indigenous peoples, with specific reference to *Guerin v. Queen*, 1984

Sample questions: “What is meant by the term ‘fiduciary duty’?” “What was the background of the *Guerin* case? What led the court to conclude that the Crown had breached a fiduciary duty in this case? What implications did this ruling have for relationships between Canadian governments and Indigenous peoples?” “How is the honour of the Crown at stake in the Crown’s fiduciary relationship with Indigenous peoples?” “How has the 2016 decision in *Daniels v. Canada* affected the Crown’s fiduciary duty towards Métis?”

C4.4 explain how various First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit political organizations (e.g., the *Assembly of First Nations*, the *Métis National Council*, *Inuit Tapiriit Kanatami*, *Pauktuutit Inuit Women of Canada*, the *Native Women’s Association of Canada*) interact with federal, provincial, and/or territorial governments, and assess the effectiveness of these interactions

Sample questions: “What are some criteria you might use to assess the productiveness of the relationship between the federal government, or provincial governments, and Indigenous organizations such as the Assembly of First Nations, Inuit Tapiriit Kanatami, and/or the Métis National Council?” “What are the goals of the Restoration of Jurisdiction Department of the Anishinabek Nation / Union of Ontario Indians, as mandated by the Anishinabek Grand Council Chiefs-in-Assembly? How do these goals affect its relationship with the provincial government?”

D. SELF-DETERMINATION, SOVEREIGNTY, AND SELF-GOVERNANCE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Land and Self-Determination:** analyse the relationship of Indigenous peoples to the land and how land-based issues are related to Indigenous rights, self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance;
- D2. Principles of Sovereignty and Self-Governance:** demonstrate an understanding of key principles of and teachings and protocols related to Indigenous sovereignty and self-governance, including an understanding of the diversity of such teachings/protocols;
- D3. Responsibilities and Self-Determination:** identify responsibilities associated with the goals of self-determination, sovereignty, self-governance, and reconciliation, and analyse strategies and practices that First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities have used and are using to pursue these goals;
- D4. The International Context:** demonstrate an understanding of the commonality of issues affecting Indigenous peoples both in Canada and around the world, with particular reference to self-determination, sovereignty, self-governance, human rights, and traditional Indigenous knowledge.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Land and Self-Determination

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** describe perceptions of land and land use that are foundational to Indigenous peoples in Canada (*e.g., regarding the use of resources, respect for the land and the living things it supports, traditional land use among different nations, land use and identity, small-scale economies and sustainability, environmental stewardship*), and compare them to the perceptions of land that predominate in Canadian society

Sample questions: “What relationship have Indigenous peoples traditionally had with the land and their territories? Do all communities/nations have the same perception of the land and land use?” “How do Indigenous peoples tend to view resource development? Are these views shared by non-Indigenous Canadians and governments?” “What are the key differences between Indigenous ideas about land use/ownership and those that came to dominate in Canada after colonization? What are the implications of the fact that the notion of

private property and the surrender of lands on that basis were, and continue to be, in opposition to traditional concepts of communal property held by Indigenous peoples?”

- D1.2** explain how various land-based issues (*e.g., territorial claims, establishing or challenging hunting and/or fishing rights, surface and subsurface rights, resource sharing, resource exploration and proposed developments, negotiating impact and benefit agreements, private ownership on reserves*) are related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance, and analyse how current laws/agreements address these issues

Sample questions: “Why are there some exemptions for Indigenous peoples in the Species at Risk Act?” “What stake do Indigenous communities have in development on or adjacent to their lands? What say do these communities have in such developments? Do you think their say should be the greater say? Why, or why not?” “Why was the Regional Framework Agreement between the Ontario government and northern First Nations to

develop the Ring of Fire viewed as a hallmark for new relationships between the government and First Nations?" "Why are harvesting rights a significant aspect of agreements and protocols for the Métis Nation? In what ways did the 2008 Métis Nation Protocol with the federal government address Métis harvesting rights and other Indigenous land-based rights?" "How are the hunting and fishing rights of a Nunavut resident different from the rights of a beneficiary of the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement?"

D1.3 analyse different types of land-based disputes that have existed and/or continue to exist between First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and federal, provincial, and/or territorial governments (*e.g., disputes over treaty violations, boundaries, access to resources, trade barriers*) and various methods that have been used to try to resolve them (*e.g., peaceful protests, armed stand-offs, blockades, mediation, arbitration, lobbying, negotiation, sanctions, court challenges*)

Sample questions: "How do First Nations, Métis, or Inuit communities lay claim to traditional territories that may currently be occupied or in the possession of others?" "What are some land-based disputes that have resulted in armed stand-offs? What did such actions accomplish? Do you think they were justified? Why, or why not?" "What promises were made to the Métis in the Manitoba Act, 1870? What action did the Manitoba Métis Federation (MMF) take in 1981 in pursuit of its land claim arising from this act? What was the significance of the Native Council of Canada joining with the MMF in this dispute?"

D1.4 assess the strengths and weaknesses of current laws and agreements in terms of their ability to protect the rights of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities in the face of human activities that affect the natural environment (*e.g., hydroelectric dams, pipelines, highways, resource extraction and processing, production of greenhouse gases*)

Sample questions: "Why is the government's 'duty to consult' important with respect to natural resource development in Canada?" "Why have some First Nations communities had long-term advisories to boil their drinking water? What does this situation reveal about the adequacy of laws protecting drinking water?" "Do you think that plans to expand pipelines adequately protect the land, including traditional Indigenous lands? Why, or why not?" "How is climate change affecting the lives of Inuit in Canada? Do you think current laws/agreements adequately address this issue? Why, or why not?"

D2. Principles of Sovereignty and Self-Governance

By the end of this course, students will:

D2.1 describe some precontact systems of self-governance among First Nations and various traditional teachings and protocols regarding self-governance and leadership in First Nations and Inuit cultures (*e.g., differences between different First Nations societies and/or between First Nations and Inuit societies; differences between patrilineal and matrilineal societies*)

Sample questions: "How did a traditional clan system of governance function?" "How did a patrilineal society such as that of the Anishinaabek Nation differ from a matrilineal society such as that of the Haudenosaunee in terms of its governance traditions and teachings?" "What are the traditional Inuit teachings about government and leadership?"

D2.2 describe the main principles of Indigenous sovereignty, self-governance, law, and leadership (*e.g., transparency, responsiveness, effectiveness, efficiency, accountability, mutual recognition, mutual respect, mutual responsibility, sharing*), and explain how they are grounded in the values and traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit societies (*e.g., values relating to land use and environmental stewardship; traditions such as respect for the role of Elders, for the autonomy of all Indigenous nations/communities, for consensus as a tool for collective survival*)

Sample questions: "Why do Indigenous peoples have an inherent right to self-government?" "In what ways does the Nisga'a Final Agreement embody some of the principles of Indigenous self-governance? What values or traditions does it reflect? In what ways might it provide a model for self-governing nations that want to embed traditional governance into their agreements?" "How does the structure of Inuit Tapiriit Kanatami reflect its approach to governance?" "What beliefs and values are embedded in the Métis Nation of Ontario's Statement of Prime Purpose?"

D2.3 describe the legal significance of particular rights sought by advocates of Indigenous sovereignty and self-governance (*e.g., the right to identify as nations, including the right to determine membership/citizenship and forms of government; the right to self-determination for each nation, including the right to define a political agenda and to develop economic, cultural, and social opportunities*)

Sample questions: “What rights with respect to sovereignty and/or self-governance did the Supreme Court of Canada articulate and affirm in *R. v. Sioui*, 1990, *R. v. Van der Peet*, 1996, *R. v. Pamajewon*, 1996, and *R. v. Powley*, 2003? What is the legal significance of such affirmations? Why are these rights being affirmed through litigation rather than negotiation? What is the significance of this approach?”

D3. Responsibilities and Self-Determination

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 identify some of the responsibilities that are associated with Indigenous self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance (e.g., *providing leadership, developing membership codes, visioning, risk management, strategic planning, community planning, community consultation, developing dispute-resolution measures and law-making procedures, financial management, human resource management, administration, external relations*), and explain some of the ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities are meeting or seeking to meet these responsibilities (e.g., *through the development of comprehensive community planning initiatives and local education mandates; by utilizing land claim settlements to provide revenue; through engagement in Western education to enhance the ability to negotiate with and influence federal and provincial governments and to infuse traditional Indigenous knowledge into educational and other institutions*)

Sample questions: “What are the responsibilities of the federal and provincial governments in supporting Indigenous sovereignty and self-governance structures in Canada?” “What is involved in the sovereignty or self-governance consultation process? Who is involved in negotiations with the Canadian government for sovereignty or self-governance?” “What are some of the responsibilities of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit leaders in developing sovereignty or self-governance proposals for their communities?” “What is the role of Métis citizens in the governance structure of the Métis Nation of Ontario?”

D3.2 describe strategies that various individuals and groups (e.g., *Elijah Harper, Phil Fontaine, Shawn Atleo, Theresa Spence, Jim Sinclair, Sheila Watt-Cloutier, the Assembly of First Nations, the Native Women’s Association of Canada, Inuit Tapiriit Kanatami, the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada, the Métis Nation of Ontario, the Indigenous Peoples’ Assembly of Canada*) have used to promote self-determination

and reconciliation for Indigenous peoples in Canada, and assess the significance of these activities

Sample questions: “What injustices did Sam George seek to end following the Ipperwash crisis? What is legally significant about the outcome of his work?” “What was the mandate of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada?” “What issues did Harry Daniels and others pursue in the courts? Why was the 2013 ruling in *Daniels v. Canada* considered a landmark decision?”

D3.3 analyse some of the calls to action in the *Final Report of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada* (e.g., *with respect to child welfare, education, language and culture, health, justice*), with particular reference to call to action number 45, to reaffirm the “nation-to-nation relationship between Aboriginal peoples and the Crown”

Sample questions: “What is the significance of call to action number 45? How does it connect reconciliation, Indigenous sovereignty and self-governance, and nation-to-nation relationship building?” “Why is it important to address the legacy of residential schools and colonial oppression through a reconciliation process in Canada?”

D3.4 explain the fiscal relationship between the federal government and Indigenous governments in Canada, including the “own-source revenue” policy, and the implications of this relationship for self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance

Sample questions: “What is the fiscal relationship between First Nations governments and the government of Canada? Why would it be more beneficial, in terms of equalizing transfer formulas for funding, for First Nations governments to be defined as nation based rather than community based?”

D3.5 describe ways in which Indigenous governments are developing local governance capacity as a means to provide effective and accountable government for their members, with particular reference to customary law or tradition (e.g., *customary care agreements, traditional chiefs and clan/family structures, traditional opening and closing ceremonies at band council meetings, the participation of Elders and knowledge keepers, consensus voting*)

Sample questions: “What are some Indigenous governance laws and customs that Indigenous governments are including in contemporary governance structures at the local level?” “What was the legal significance of the 1996 decision

in *Bone v. Sioux Valley Indian Band No. 290 Council* with respect to inherent rights to practices, customs, and traditions?”

D4. The International Context

By the end of this course, students will:

D4.1 explain how some factors that affect the self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance of Indigenous peoples in Canada also affect Indigenous peoples in other parts of the world (*e.g., with reference to human rights, environmental protection, collective security, boundary disputes, trade and tariff barriers, international support for the rights of Indigenous peoples*)

Sample questions: “What are some ways in which environmental laws – or the lack of such laws – have affected Indigenous peoples in different parts of the world? What parallels can you find between this impact and the experience of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit communities in Canada?”

D4.2 assess the strengths and weaknesses of international agreements aimed at protecting various categories of rights and freedoms that are of importance to Indigenous peoples in Canada and around the world (*e.g., declarations/agreements relating to women’s rights, the rights of children and youth, religious rights, education rights; the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples*)

Sample questions: “What are some key international agreements intended to protect rights that are of importance to Indigenous peoples? Which countries and Indigenous communities were involved in establishing these agreements?” “What are some circumstances that can limit the effectiveness with which international agreements can protect the fundamental rights and freedoms of Indigenous peoples around the world?” “How effective do you think the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples has been, both in Canada and internationally? Do you think it could play a role in shaping the future relationship between the Crown and Métis in Canada? Why, or why not?”

D4.3 describe some ways in which Indigenous individuals and organizations in Canada have engaged in national and international forums and with non-governmental and/or intergovernmental organizations to forward political and legal issues (*e.g., with reference to the UN, the Institute on Governance, Amnesty International, Human Rights Watch, the Inuit Circumpolar Council*)

Sample questions: “What role does the UN play in supporting or strengthening the pursuit of sovereignty and self-governance initiatives of Indigenous peoples in Canada?” “What might be some benefits of Indigenous individuals and/or organizations in Canada aligning themselves with Indigenous organizations globally?”

D4.4 analyse the impact of technological advances on Indigenous peoples in Canada and around the world (*e.g., with reference to information and communications technology; technologies relating to resource exploration and extraction, surveillance, medical science, trade and finance, transportation*)

Sample questions: “How do advances in communications technology enable governments to monitor the activities of individuals and groups? What impact can such monitoring have on Indigenous peoples?” “In what ways can advances in information and communications technology support cooperation and knowledge sharing between Indigenous communities and advocacy groups on a global scale?” “What is the relationship between Indigenous knowledge systems and Western and/or Eastern approaches to medicine? In what ways are developments in Western medical science compatible with traditional knowledge? In what ways are they incompatible? What is the significance of this relationship for Indigenous peoples?” “How might technology enhance economic/financial progress in Indigenous communities in Canada and in other countries around the world? How might technology hinder economic progress in these communities or endanger traditional ways of life?”

D4.5 describe some ways in which peoples around the world have used traditional Indigenous knowledge to address governance issues (*e.g., with reference to planning for future generations, protecting the environment, problem solving, strategic planning*), and compare these approaches with those of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit leaders in Canada

Sample questions: “How is traditional Indigenous knowledge being used to address critical global issues such as climate change, water security, and food security?” “Who are some of the leaders in the area of Indigenous law and self-determination for Indigenous peoples, in Canada and globally? In what ways do their ideas reflect traditional Indigenous knowledge?”